

OCR Level 1/2 GCSE (9–1) in English Language (J351)

Specification

Version 1: First Assessment 2017

This draft qualification has not yet been accredited by Ofqual. It is published to enable teachers to have early sight of our proposed approach to GCSE in English Language. Further changes may be required and no assurance can be given at this time that the proposed qualification will be made available in its current form, or that it will be accredited in time for first teaching in 2015 and first award in 2017.

Draft

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1 Why choose an OCR GCSE in English Language?

1a. Why choose an OCR qualification?

Choose OCR and you've got the reassurance that you're working with one of the UK's leading exam boards. Our new GCSE in English Language course has been developed in consultation with teachers, employers and Higher Education to provide students with a qualification that's relevant to them and meets their needs.

We're part of the Cambridge Assessment Group, Europe's largest assessment agency and a department of the University of Cambridge. Cambridge Assessment plays a leading role in developing and delivering assessments throughout the world, operating in over 150 countries.

We work with a range of education providers, including schools, colleges, workplaces and other institutions in both the public and private sectors. Over 13,000 centres choose our A levels, GCSEs and vocational qualifications including Cambridge Nationals, Cambridge Technicals and Cambridge Progression.

Our Specifications

We believe in developing specifications that help you bring the subject to life and inspire your students to achieve more.

We've created teacher-friendly specifications based on extensive research and engagement with the teaching community. They're designed to be straightforward and accessible so that you can tailor the delivery of the course to suit your needs. We aim to

encourage learners to become responsible for their own learning, confident in discussing ideas, innovative and engaged.

We provide a range of support services designed to help you at every stage, from preparation through to the delivery of our specifications. This includes:

- A wide range of high-quality creative resources including:
 - o Delivery Guides
 - o Transition Guides
 - o Topic Exploration Packs
 - o Lesson Elements
 - o ...and much more.
- Access to subject specialists to support you through the transition and throughout the lifetime of the specifications.
- CPD/Training for teachers including face-to-face events to introduce the qualifications and prepare you for first teaching.
- Active Results – our free results analysis service to help you review the performance of individual students or whole schools.
- ExamCreator – our new online past papers service that enables you to build your own test papers from past OCR exam questions.

All GCSE qualifications offered by OCR are accredited by Ofqual, the Regulator for qualifications offered in England.

1b. Why choose an OCR GCSE in English Language?

OCR's GCSE in English Language specification is designed to help learners explore communication, culture and creativity, to develop independent and critical thinking and to engage with the richness of our language and literary heritage.

At GCSE, learners will develop the skills to read fluently and write effectively. They are encouraged to engage with a wide variety of high-quality texts both literary and non-fiction, across a range of familiar genres. They will develop the skills to analyse critically and synthesise and evaluate ideas and information across unseen texts.

Learners will be given the opportunity to experiment in their writing across a range of contexts and styles. Learners will use knowledge gained from wider reading to inform their written work. They will be able to write grammatically correct sentences, with accurate spelling and punctuation and utilise a range of structural devices.

Learners will also develop a confident control of spoken Standard English and demonstrate the ability to use spoken language appropriately in formal settings.

This provides them with a solid grounding, whether going on to Further Education, Higher Education or the workplace.

Aims and learning outcomes

This specification enables learners to:

- read a wide range of texts fluently and with good understanding and analyse them critically
- use the knowledge they have gained from wide reading to inform and improve their own writing
- write effectively and coherently, demonstrating a confident control of Standard English and using it appropriately
- develop and apply a knowledge of the linguistic conventions for reading, writing and spoken language
- use grammar correctly, punctuate and spell accurately and deploy figurative language effectively
- acquire and apply a wide vocabulary, alongside a knowledge and understanding of grammatical terminology
- listen to and understand spoken language and use their own spoken Standard English effectively.

1c. What are the key features of this specification?

This specification encourages learners to read critically and use the knowledge they gain from wide reading to improve their own writing.

The clear distinction between the two components develops learners' awareness of how different types of texts are crafted. Component 01 develops understanding of reading and writing non-fiction texts and component 02 explores literary and creative writing. This is designed to support learners' development as critical readers and help them make conscious choices when planning and crafting their own writing.

This qualification will enable learners to develop:

- knowledge and understanding of a wide range of engaging texts drawn from

literary and non-fiction sources; these may include, for example, prose fiction, journalism, travel writing and biographical writing

- critical responses to high-quality unseen texts from the 19th, 20th and 21st centuries. This provides learners with an enriched curriculum that can be effectively integrated with the OCR GCSE in English Literature course
- creative and imaginative writing skills and the ability to write accurately for a range of purposes and audiences, using their understanding of linguistic and literary methods
- confident spoken language and listening skills to communicate clearly and effectively.

1d. How do I find out more information?

If you are already using OCR specifications you can contact us at: www.ocr.org.uk

If you are not already a registered OCR centre then you can find out more information on the benefits of becoming one at: www.ocr.org.uk

Find out more?

Ask a subject specialist:

Email: ocrenglish@ocr.org.uk

Customer Contact Centre: 01223 553998

Teacher support: www.ocr.org.uk

2 The specification overview

2a. The Overview of GCSE in English Language (J351)

Learners must complete all components (01, 02 and 03 or 04) to be awarded the GCSE in English Language.

Content Overview	Assessment Overview	
- Communicating information and ideas (component 01) focuses on reading and writing non-fiction texts. - Learners read and compare non-fiction texts: one 19th century non-fiction text and one 20th or 21st century text. - Learners write one piece of original non-fiction. - Exploring effects and impact (component 02) focuses on reading literary prose texts and creative writing. - Learners read and respond to literary prose texts, one text may be literary non-fiction. - Both texts are 20th or 21st century literary prose. There will not be a 19th century text in component 02. - Learners write one piece of original creative writing. - Spoken language (component 03 or 04) focuses on speaking and listening skills. - Learners present information and ideas in spoken presentations and listen and respond to others appropriately.	Communicating information and ideas (01)* 80 marks 2 hour written paper	50% of total GCSE
	Exploring effects and impact (02)* 80 marks 2 hour written paper	50% of total GCSE
	Spoken language (03 or 04) 40 marks Internal assessment (Details to be confirmed by Ofqual)	0% of total GCSE

* Indicates synoptic assessment

2b. Content of GCSE in English Language (J351)

The OCR GCSE in English Language specification aims to encourage learners to:

- read a wide range of texts fluently and critically
- write effectively, accurately and coherently for different audiences and purposes
- speak clearly and confidently in a range of contexts.

Reading

All texts in the examination are unseen, that is, learners will not have studied the examination texts during the course.

The unseen texts will be selected from a range of genres, including prose fiction, literary non-fiction and other non-fiction such as journalism, biography and travel writing.

High-quality texts will be drawn from the 19th, 20th and 21st centuries. The 19th century text will always be non-fiction.

Drama and poetry are **not** included in the OCR GCSE in English Language qualification.

Writing

OCR's GCSE in English Language is designed to enable learners to develop expertise in their writing. Learners are encouraged to develop their ability to adapt their writing for a range of different purposes and contexts. The accuracy of grammar, punctuation and spelling is important, as is the ability to use Standard English when appropriate. Learners write creatively and imaginatively, using a wide vocabulary with a clear awareness of audience.

Spoken Language

Learners will have the opportunity to prepare spoken presentations, planning effectively for different audiences and purposes. They will listen and respond to others and express themselves using Standard English when appropriate.

2c. Content of Communicating information and ideas (Component 01)

Component 01 has two sections:

- Section A: Reading information and ideas
- Section B: Writing for audience, impact and purpose.

For Section A, learners read and respond to unseen non-fiction texts, one of which is a 19th century text.

For Section B, they produce a piece of non-fiction writing.

Learners develop knowledge and understanding of how writers communicate for different audiences, purposes and contexts.

The following tables set out the content of GCSE in English Language, component 01, Section A and Section B. These provide details on the required knowledge, understanding and skills for each section.

Content of Reading information and ideas (01)		
Section A	Content	Learners should be able to:
Read unseen non-fiction texts from the 19th century and either the 20th or 21st century. One text will always be drawn from the 19th century.	Learners read a wide range of high-quality non-fiction texts drawn from the 19th and either the 20th or 21st century. This may include for example, essays, journalism (both printed and online), travel writing, speeches and biographical writing. Learners are required to read in different ways for different purposes. They read and analyse texts that are designed, for example, to persuade, inform, instruct or advise. They explore how effectively texts achieve their purposes by comparing and evaluating the usefulness, relevance and presentation of ideas and information. Learners engage with texts, developing independent viewpoints and recognising different interpretations. They develop knowledge and understanding of linguistic and literary terminology to support their analysis of texts.	• identify and interpret key ideas and information from texts • comment on writers' choices of vocabulary, form and grammatical features, paying attention to detail • explore the effects of writing for particular audiences and purposes • summarise ideas and information from a single text and synthesise from more than one text • draw inferences and justify points of view by referring closely to evidence from the text • use appropriate linguistic terminology to support their analysis • evaluate the usefulness of a text by identifying bias and misuse of evidence • use a broad understanding of the text's context to inform their reading. Contexts could include, for example the given historical setting, the mode or genre • explore connections across texts to develop their understanding of the ideas, attitudes and values presented in them.

Content of Writing for audience, impact and purpose (01)		
Section B	Content	Learners should be able to:
Writing original non-fiction for different audiences and purposes.	Learners produce clear and coherent non-fiction pieces, including writing to: • explain • inform • instruct • argue • persuade. Learners produce original texts in a range of non-fiction forms, for example, articles, speeches and letters. They develop skills to adapt their writing for different purposes, audiences and contexts. Learners explore how vocabulary and grammatical features can be used to achieve particular effects. They use techniques identified from their wide reading of non-fiction texts to achieve specific effects. Learners apply their knowledge and understanding of appropriate linguistic conventions and use rhetorical devices effectively.	• organise ideas and information clearly and coherently • select and emphasise key ideas and information to influence readers and reflect the purpose of the writing • maintain a consistent viewpoint across a non-fiction piece of writing • make considered choices of vocabulary and grammar to reflect particular audiences, purposes and contexts • adapt tone, style and register as appropriate • use the knowledge gained from wider reading of non-fiction to inform language choices and techniques • make appropriate use of information provided by others to write in different forms • cite evidence and quotation effectively to support views • use a range of sentence structures for clarity, purpose and effect, with accurate punctuation and spelling.

2c. Content of Exploring effects and impact (Component 02)

Component 02 has two sections:

- Section A: Reading meaning and effects
- Section B: Writing imaginatively and creatively.

For Section A, learners read and respond to unseen prose fiction texts drawn from the 20th and/or 21st century. One text may be literary non-fiction.

For Section B, they produce a piece of original creative writing.

Learners develop knowledge and understanding of writers' use of language and techniques to create meaning and effects in narrative fiction and literary non-fiction.

The following tables set out the content of GCSE in English Language, component 02, Section A and Section B. These provide details on the required knowledge, understanding and skills for each section.

Content of Reading meaning and effects (02)		
Section A	Content	Learners should be able to:
Reading unseen prose fiction texts from the 20th and/or 21st century. One text may be literary non-fiction.	Learners read a wide range of high-quality prose fiction texts drawn from the 20th and/or 21st century. This may include, for example, extracts from novels, short stories or literary non-fiction such as autobiography. Learners engage with the detail in texts to draw inferences and recognise the possibility of different reactions. They explore the impact of writers' uses of language, structure and grammatical features on the reader. Learners support their ideas about texts with carefully selected evidence. They develop knowledge and understanding of linguistic and literary terminology to support their analysis of texts.	• comment on writers' choices of vocabulary, form and grammatical features and how these create meaning • analyse and compare writers' use of language, paying attention to detail • draw inferences and justify points of view by referring closely to evidence from the text • interpret writers' meanings and effects in single texts and across two texts • identify the main themes and ideas in texts • use appropriate linguistic and literary terminology to support their analysis • evaluate how form and structure contribute to the effectiveness and impact of a text • use a broad understanding of the text's context to inform their reading. Contexts could include for example, the setting or genre • explore connections across texts to develop their understanding of the ideas, attitudes and values presented in them.

Content of Writing imaginatively and creatively (02)		
Section B	Content	Learners should be able to:
Producing original creative writing.	Learners produce imaginative, original texts in a range of forms, including, for example, short stories and autobiographical writing. They use narrative techniques identified from their wide reading of prose fiction texts to achieve deliberate effects in their own writing. Learners explore how vocabulary and grammatical features can be used to achieve particular effects. They develop skills to adapt their writing for different purposes and contexts. Learners apply their knowledge and understanding of linguistic and literary conventions to create impact in their own writing.	• organise and structure ideas in narrative writing to create deliberate effects • maintain a consistent viewpoint across a piece of writing, making conscious decisions, for example, about narrative point of view • make considered choices of vocabulary and grammar to create deliberate effects • use the knowledge gained from wide reading of prose fiction and literary non-fiction to inform language choices and techniques • use language creatively and imaginatively • adapt tone, style and register as appropriate • select and emphasise key ideas to create meaning and influence readers • use a range of sentence structures for clarity, purpose and effect, with accurate punctuation and spelling.

2d. Content of non exam assessment in GCSE in English Language (Details to be confirmed by Ofqual)

Content: Spoken language (Component 03 or 04)

In the Spoken language component, learners develop their spoken language skills by planning and preparing presentations for different purposes and audiences. They will listen and respond to others and express their ideas using Standard English when appropriate.

The following tables set out the content of GCSE in English language, component 03 or

04. These provide details on the required knowledge, understanding and skills.

The preparation and assessment of Spoken language is a compulsory requirement of the course of study. It will appear on all students' certificates as a separately reported grade, alongside the overall grade issued. Ofqual will be consulting shortly on the marking and grading arrangements.

Content of non exam assessment of GCSE in English Language		
	Content	Learners should be able to:
Presenting information and ideas Responding to spoken language Spoken Standard English	To be confirmed by Ofqual Performance will be assessed against common assessment criteria issued by the exam boards. The criteria will address the following assessment objectives: • AO7 – Demonstrate presentation skills in a formal setting • AO8 – Listen and respond appropriately to spoken language, including to questions and feedback to presentations • AO9 – Use spoken Standard English effectively in speeches and presentations. The final assessment criteria and requirements for assessment, that will be consistent across all exam boards, will appear in the final accredited specifications.	• select information and ideas for prepared spoken presentations • organise information and ideas effectively and persuasively • plan effectively for different purposes and audiences • make presentations and speeches in a formal setting. • listen carefully to any questions and feedback • respond appropriately • express ideas using Standard English whenever and wherever appropriate.

2e. Prior learning and progression

Learners in England who are beginning a GCSE course are likely to have followed a Key Stage 3 programme of study. No prior knowledge of this subject is required.

GCSEs are qualifications that enable learners to progress to further qualifications either Vocational or General.

This qualification provides the ideal foundation for learners to progress to OCR AS Level and A Level English qualifications: English Language, English Literature or English Language and Literature (EMC).

Find out more at www.ocr.org.uk

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3 Assessment of OCR GCSE in English Language

3a. Forms of assessment

The OCR GCSE in English Language (J351) is a linear qualification with 100% external assessment.

This qualification consists of two examined components, externally assessed by OCR. Both examinations are of two hours duration, each with a 50% weighting. The Spoken language component is a separate

compulsory endorsement which is internally assessed and externally moderated.

All texts in the examination will be unseen, that is, learners will not have studied the examination texts during the course. These unseen texts will be drawn from each of the following three centuries; the 19th century; the 20th and the 21st century.

Communicating information and ideas (01)

This component is worth 80 marks: 40 marks for Section A and 40 marks for Section B.

Learners answer **all** the questions in Section A. Learners read and respond to two unseen authentic non-fiction texts. One text is from the 19th century; the other is from either the 20th or 21st century. There are four reading questions - two lower tariff and two higher tariff questions. (40 marks, 25% of total GCSE).

Learners answer **one** of two extended writing tasks in Section B. The writing tasks will have a clear audience and purpose and be written in a non-fiction form. There will be links between the theme or idea in the reading texts and the writing task. (40 marks, 25% of total GCSE).

Exploring effects and impact (02)

This component is worth 80 marks: 40 marks for Section A and 40 marks for Section B.

Learners answer **all** the questions in Section A. Learners read and respond to two unseen authentic prose fiction texts or a prose fiction and literary non-fiction text. Both texts will be either 20th or 21st century prose. There are four reading questions – two lower tariff and

two higher tariff questions. (40 marks, 25% of total GCSE).

Learners answer **one** of two extended writing tasks in Section B. The focus is on creative writing. There will be links between the theme or idea in the reading texts and the writing task. (40 marks, 25% of total GCSE).

Spoken language (03 or 04) (Details to be confirmed by Ofqual)

Spoken language is a separate compulsory endorsement, internally assessed and externally moderated.

The marks for the Spoken language component do not contribute to the overall GCSE grade.

Learners will be assessed on the following skills:

- presenting information and ideas, selecting and organising information effectively and persuasively
- listening and responding appropriately to questions and feedback
- expressing ideas using Standard English when appropriate.

3b. Assessment availability

There will be:

- one examination series available each year in June to **all** learners
- one examination series in November each year available **only** to learners who have reached at least the age of 16 on or before 31st August of that calendar year.

This specification will be certificated from the June 2017 examination series onwards.

3c. Assessment Objectives (AO)

There are six assessment objectives for OCR's GCSE in English Language: Communicating information and ideas and Exploring effects and impact. These are detailed in the table below:

Learners are expected to demonstrate their ability to:

	Assessment Objective
AO1	Identify and interpret explicit and implicit information and ideas. Select and synthesise evidence from different texts.
AO2	Explain, comment on and analyse how writers use language and structure to achieve effects and influence readers, using relevant subject terminology to support their views.
AO3	Compare writers' ideas and perspectives, as well as how these are conveyed, across two or more texts.
AO4	Evaluate texts critically and support this with appropriate textual references.
AO5	Communicate clearly, effectively and imaginatively, selecting and adapting tone, style and register for different forms, purposes and audiences. Organise information and ideas, using structural and grammatical features to support coherence and cohesion of texts.
AO6	Use a range of vocabulary and sentence structures for clarity, purpose and effect, with accurate spelling and punctuation.

There are three assessment objectives for GCSE English Language: Spoken language. These are detailed in the table below:

Learners are expected to demonstrate their ability to:

	Assessment Objective
AO7	Demonstrate presentation skills in a formal setting.
AO8	Listen and respond appropriately to spoken language, including to questions and feedback to presentations.
AO9	Use spoken Standard English effectively in speeches and presentations.

AO weightings in GCSE English Language

The relationship between the assessment objectives and the components are shown in the following table:

Component	GCSE External Assessment						
	AO1	AO2	AO3	AO4	AO5	AO6	Total
Communicating information and ideas J351/01	6.25%	7.5%	3.75%	7.5%	15%	10%	50%
Exploring effects and impact J351/02	2.5%	11.25%	3.75%	7.5%	15%	10%	50%
	8.75%	18.75%	7.5%	15%	30%	20%	100%

Details to be confirmed by Ofqual

The preparation and assessment of Spoken language is a compulsory requirement of the course of study. It will appear on all students' certificates as a separately reported grade, alongside the overall grade issued. Ofqual will be consulting shortly on the marking and

grading arrangements. Performance will be assessed against common assessment criteria issued by the exam boards. The final assessment criteria and requirements for assessment, that will be consistent across all exam boards, will appear in the final accredited specifications.

Component	Non-exam assessment			
	AO7	AO8	AO9	Total
Spoken Language J351/03 or J351/04	TBC%	TBC%	TBC%	100%
	TBC%	TBC%	TBC%	100%

3d. Assessment of extended responses

The assessment materials for this qualification provide learners with the opportunity to demonstrate their ability to construct and develop a sustained line of reasoning and marks for extended responses are integrated into the marking criteria.

Learners will be assessed on the use of a range of vocabulary and sentence structures

for clarity, purpose and effect, with accurate spelling and punctuation (AO6) in Section B of each examined component.

AO6 will carry a 20% weighting in this GCSE in English Language qualification.

3e. Non exam assessment: Spoken language (03 or 04) (Details to be confirmed by Ofqual)

The preparation and assessment of Spoken language is a compulsory requirement of the course of study. It will appear on all students' certificates as a separately reported grade, alongside the overall grade issued. Ofqual will be consulting shortly on the marking and grading arrangements. Performance will be

assessed against common assessment criteria issued by the exam boards. The final assessment criteria and requirements for assessment, that will be consistent across all exam boards, will appear in the final accredited specifications.

3e. Non exam assessment: Spoken language – Marking Criteria (Details to be confirmed by Ofqual)

The preparation and assessment of Spoken language is a compulsory requirement of the course of study. It will appear on all students' certificates as a separately reported grade, alongside the overall grade issued. Ofqual will be consulting shortly on the marking and grading arrangements. Performance will be assessed against common assessment criteria issued by the exam boards. The final assessment criteria and requirements for assessment, that will be consistent across all exam boards, will appear in the final accredited specifications.

Band/Marks	
Band 3 TBC	Candidates: • To be confirmed by Ofqual
Band 2 TBC	Candidates: • To be confirmed by Ofqual
Band 1 TBC	Candidates: • To be confirmed by Ofqual

0 marks = no response or no response worthy of credit

3f. Synoptic assessment

This GCSE in English Language specification focuses on skills-based learning. The ability to acquire and apply knowledge and understanding within frameworks of analysis is transferable to other subjects. Close reading, the exploration of referential and inferential meanings and the summarising and synthesising of information are essential skills developed through this qualification. The unseen nature of the assessment encourages independent thought and response and requires a selective application of the analytical tools necessary for critical evaluation in other subjects.

The ability to communicate using an accurate application of Standard English is essential to express ideas in all subjects.

The two externally assessed components in OCR's GCSE in English Language provide an integrated focus. In each component, texts are linked thematically through stimulating reading tasks, to provide a foundation for the writing section. The assessment model has a straightforward design, mirrored in both components.

Both the OCR GCSE in English Language and the OCR GCSE in English Literature include the study of literary texts. The inclusion of 19th century non-fiction texts in English Language helps to contextualise the study of the 19th century novel in English Literature.

Both OCR GCSE English specifications assess learners' ability to make connections between texts. In some cases these connections may be obvious, in others the connection will be more implicit. In both specifications, there is no predetermined set of ways in which the texts relate, leaving learners free to explore a range of possibilities. Learners can begin to discover how understanding of one text is illuminated by its relationship with another.

The use of unseen material in all GCSE English examinations allows learners to draw on analytical skills developed in both OCR GCSE English Language and GCSE English Literature and offers the potential to stretch learners to produce fresh and sophisticated responses to texts encountered for the first time.

3g. Calculating Qualification Results

A learner's overall qualification grade for GCSE in English Language will be calculated by adding together their marks from the two examined components taken to give their total weighted mark

This mark will then be compared to the qualification level grade boundaries for the relevant exam series to determine the learner's overall qualification grade.

A learner's mark for their non exam assessment component will not contribute to their overall qualification grade. This mark will be compared to the component grade boundaries for the relevant exam series to determine their separate grade for the Spoken language endorsement.

4 Admin: What you need to know

The information in this section is designed to give an overview of the processes involved in administering this qualification so that you can speak to your exams officer. All of the following processes require you to submit something to OCR by a specific deadline.

More information about these processes, together with the deadlines can be found in the *OCR Admin Guide and Entry Codes: 14–19 Qualifications*, which can be downloaded from the OCR website: www.ocr.org.uk

4a. Pre-assessment

Estimated entries

Estimated entries are your best projection of the number of learners who will be entered for a qualification in a particular series.

Estimated entries should be submitted to OCR by the specified deadline. They are free and do not commit your centre in any way.

Final entries

Final entries provide OCR with detailed data for each learner, showing each assessment to be taken. It is essential that you use the correct entry code, considering the relevant entry rules and ensuring that you choose the entry option for the moderation you intend to use.

Final entries must be submitted to OCR by the published deadlines or late entry fees will apply.

All learners taking GCSE in English Language must be entered for one of the entry options shown on the following table:

Entry code	Title	Component code	Component title	Assessment type
J351A	English Language	01	Communicating information and ideas	External Assessment
		02	Exploring effects and impact	External Assessment
		03	Spoken language	Internal Assessment (OCR Repository)
J351B	English Language	01	Communicating information and ideas	External Assessment
		02	Exploring effects and impact	External Assessment
		04	Spoken language	Internal Assessment (Postal moderation)
J351C*	English Language	01	Communicating information and ideas	External Assessment
		02	Exploring effects and impact	External Assessment
		80	Spoken language	Internal Assessment (Carried forward)

*Entry option J351C should only be selected for learners who are re-taking the qualification who want to carry forward their result for the non-exam assessment.

Estimated grades

An estimated grade is the grade the centre expects a learner to achieve for a

qualification. These grades should be submitted to OCR by the specified deadline.

4b. Accessibility and special consideration

The GCSE qualification and subject criteria have been reviewed in order to identify any feature which could disadvantage candidates who share a protected Characteristic as defined by the Equality Act 2010. All reasonable steps have been taken to minimise any such disadvantage.

Reasonable adjustments and access arrangements allow learners with special educational needs, disabilities or temporary injuries to access the assessment and show what they know and can do, without changing the demands of the assessment. Applications

for these should be made before the examination series. Detailed information about eligibility for access arrangements can be found in the *JCQ Access Arrangements and Reasonable Adjustments*.

Special consideration is a post-assessment adjustment to marks or grades to reflect temporary injury, illness or other indisposition at the time the assessment was taken. Detailed information about eligibility for special consideration can be found in the *JCQ A guide to the special consideration process*.

4c. External assessment arrangements (Details to be confirmed by Ofqual)

The preparation and assessment of Spoken language is a compulsory requirement of the course of study. It will appear on all students' certificates as a separately reported grade, alongside the overall grade issued. Ofqual will be consulting shortly on the marking and grading arrangements. Performance will be assessed against common assessment criteria issued by the exam boards. The final

assessment criteria and requirements for assessment, that will be consistent across all exam boards, will appear in the final accredited specifications.

Regulations governing examination arrangements are contained in the JCQ *Instructions for conducting examinations*.

4d. Non exam assessment

Regulations governing arrangements for internal assessments are contained in the JCQ *Instructions for conducting coursework*.

Carrying forward non exam assessment (Details to be confirmed by Ofqual)

The preparation and assessment of Spoken language is a compulsory requirement of the course of study. It will appear on all students' certificates as a separately reported grade, alongside the overall grade issued. Ofqual will be consulting shortly on the marking and grading arrangements. Performance will be assessed against common assessment

criteria issued by the exam boards. The final assessment criteria and requirements for assessment, that will be consistent across all exam boards, will appear in the final accredited specifications.

Authentication of learner's work

Learners and centres must declare that the work is the learner's own.

Teachers must declare that the work submitted for internal assessment is the

learner's own work by submitting a centre authentication form (CCS160) for each internally assessed component. This should be sent to the moderator at the same time as the marks.

Internal standardisation

Centres must carry out internal standardisation to ensure that marks awarded by different teachers are accurate

and consistent across all learners entered for the component from that centre.

Moderation (Details to be confirmed by Ofqual)

The preparation and assessment of Spoken language is a compulsory requirement of the course of study. It will appear on all students' certificates as a separately reported grade, alongside the overall grade issued. Ofqual will be consulting shortly on the marking and grading arrangements. Performance will be assessed against common assessment

criteria issued by the exam boards. The final assessment criteria and requirements for assessment, that will be consistent across all exam boards, will appear in the final accredited specifications.

4e. Results and certificates (Details to be confirmed by Ofqual)

Grade scale

GCSE qualifications are graded on the scale: 9–1, where 9 is the highest. Learners who fail to reach the minimum standard of 1 will be Unclassified (U). Only subjects in which grades 9 to 1 are attained will be recorded on certificates.

The Spoken language component will be graded on the scale: Distinction, Merit, Pass, where Distinction is the highest. Learners who fail to reach the minimum standard of Pass will be Unclassified (U). Where a grade of Distinction, Merit or Pass is attained this will be recorded on the certificate alongside the learner's qualification grade.

Results

Results are released to centres and learners for information and to allow any queries to be resolved before certificates are issued.

Centres will have access to the following results information for each learner:

- the grade for the qualification
- the grade for the Spoken language endorsement
- the raw mark for each component
- the total weighted mark for the qualification.

The following supporting information will be available:

- raw mark grade boundaries for each component
- weighted mark grade boundaries for each entry option.

Until certificates are issued, results are deemed to be provisional and may be subject to amendment. A learner's final results will be recorded on an OCR certificate.

The qualification title will be shown on the certificate as 'OCR Level 1/2 GCSE in English Language'.

4f. Post-results services

A number of post-results services are available:

- **Enquiries about results** – If you are not happy with the outcome of a learner's results, centres may submit an enquiry about results.
- **Missing and incomplete results** – This service should be used if an individual subject result for a learner is missing, or the learner has been

omitted entirely from the results supplied.

- **Access to scripts** – Centres can request access to marked scripts.

4g. Malpractice

Any breach of the regulations for the conduct of examinations and coursework may constitute malpractice (which includes maladministration) and must be reported to OCR as soon as it is detected. Detailed

information on malpractice can be found in the *Suspected Malpractice in Examinations and Assessments: Policies and Procedures* published by JCQ.

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5 Appendices

5a. Grade descriptors

To be confirmed by Ofqual.

5b. Overlap with other qualifications

There is some overlap between the content of this specification and that of specifications in OCR's GCSE in English Literature.

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